

RICCARDO DI FRANCESCO

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[Website](#) ◊ [GitHub](#)

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(This version: *April 2026*)

CURRENT POSITION

Postdoctoral Researcher

Oct. 2024–Present

Principal Investigator: *Seetha Menon*

University of Southern Denmark, Odense

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics and Finance

Sept. 2024

Advisor: *Franco Peracchi*

Co-advisor: *Tommaso Proietti*

Thesis: *“Three Essays in Causal Inference and Machine Learning”*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Master of Science in Economics

July 2020

Advisor: *Alberto Iozzi*

Thesis: *“Fleet Competition with Autonomous Vehicles: the Role of Ownership”*

Final Grade: 110/110 *summa cum laude*

University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome

Bachelor of Science in Political Economics

Oct. 2018

Advisor: *Francesco Nucci*

Thesis: *“Macroeconomic Impacts of Brexit”*

Final Grade: 107/110

University of Rome La Sapienza, Rome

RESEARCH VISITS

VinUniversity, Hanoi

Nov. 2025

Research visit to NLP Research Group

Host: *Mo El-Haj*

Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research, St. Gallen

Feb.–Dec. 2022

Visiting Ph.D. Student

Host: *Michael Lechner*

RESEARCH

Publications

- Di Francesco, R. (2026). [Aggregation Trees](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 45(5), 634–659.
- Di Francesco, R., & Mellace, G. (2025). [Causal inference for qualitative outcomes](#). *Economics Letters*, 112626.
- Di Francesco, R. (2025). [Ordered Correlation Forest](#). *Econometric Reviews*, 44(4), 416–432.

Working Papers

- [Behavioral Consequences of Sexual Orientation Disclosure in a Large-Scale Digital Environment](#) (joint with [Enzo Brox](#)). *arXiv preprint arXiv:2403.03649*.

Software

- causalQual: Causal Inference for Qualitative Outcomes. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- valiCATE: Validation of CATE models. ([Website](#))
- ocf: Ordered Correlation Forest. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))
- aggTrees: Aggregation Trees. ([Website](#) | [CRAN](#))

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Conference Reviewer 2026 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) University of the Basque Country, Bilbao	<i>Jan. 2026</i>
Conference Reviewer 2025 Annual Meeting of the European Association of Young Economists (EAYE) King's College London, London	<i>Jan. 2025</i>
Conference Co-organizer and Scientific Committee Member 1st Tor Vergata Ph.D. Conference in Economics University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome	<i>Sept. 2024</i>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant Paper: <i>A further look at the gender gap in Italian academic careers</i> Authors: Marianna Brunetti, Annalisa Fabretti, Mariangela Zoli	<i>Oct. 2023</i>
Research Assistant Paper: <i>Teaching an old dog a new trick: Reserve price and unverifiable quality in repeated procurement</i> Authors: Gian Luigi Albano, Berardino Cesi, Alberto Iozzi	<i>July 2022</i>

SEMINARS AND CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

2026 (*including scheduled*)

- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- Frontiers of Causal Inference and Machine Learning (CIML, invited presentation).
- European Association of Young Economists Annual Meeting (EAYE).
- VIVE – Danish Center for Social Science Research (invited presentation).

2025

- 16th International Health Economics Association World Congress (IHEA).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE).
- 38th Annual Conference of the European Society for Population Economics (ESPE).
- 11th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2024

- CSQIEP Virtual Seminar.
- Rome Conference on Econometrics: Frontiers in Casual Inference.
- 3rd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 29th International Panel Data Conference (IPDC).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Thessaloniki).
- Annual Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics (IAAE Xiamen).
- Annual Conference of the Scottish Economic Society (SES).

2023

- 2nd Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 11th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).
- 10th Italian Congress of Econometrics and Empirical Economics (ICEEE).

2022

- 1st Rome Ph.D. in Economics and Finance Conference.
- 10th SIde Workshop for Ph.D. students in Econometrics and Empirical Economics (WEEE).

REFEREE ACTIVITIES

- Social Indicators Research

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Emerging Econometrician Award <i>Econometric Reviews</i> —Winner for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>Oct. 2025</i>
Student Best Paper Award <i>IAAE 2024 Thessaloniki</i> —Honorable mention for the paper <i>Ordered Correlation Forest</i> .	<i>June 2024</i>
Ph.D. Scholarship <i>University of Rome Tor Vergata</i> —Scholarship fully financing Ph.D. studies.	<i>Oct. 2020</i>

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Guest Lecturer in Microeconometrics Master of Science course, taught by Giovanni Mellace University of Southern Denmark, Odense	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2025</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistics Bachelor of Science course, taught by Livia De Giovanni LUISS University, Rome	<i>Feb.–May 2024</i>
Teaching Assistant in Applied Statistics and Econometrics Bachelor of Science course, taught by Marianna Brunetti LUISS University, Rome	<i>Oct.–Dec. 2023</i>
Teaching Assistant in Statistical Learning Master of Science course, taught by Tommaso Proietti University of Rome Tor Vergata, Rome	<i>Sept.–Oct. 2021</i>

OTHER RELEVANT EXPERIENCES

Econometric Games—Team Captain Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2023</i>
Summer School in Causal Machine Learning Lecturer: Michael Lechner University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>Oct. 2022</i>
Summer School in Theoretical Aspects of Machine Learning Lecturer: Petyo Bonev University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>June 2022</i>
Summer School in Econometrics of Big Data Lecturers: Christian Hansen, Martin Spindler University of St. Gallen, St. Gallen	<i>June 2022</i>
Econometric Games—Team Captain Selected to lead the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2022</i>
Summer School in Semiparametric Learning Lecturer: Yanyuan Ma University of Trento, Trento	<i>July 2021</i>
Summer School in Microeconometrics and Machine Learning for Policy Evaluation Lecturers: David Margolis, Philipp Ketz, Margherita Comola Paris School of Economics, Paris	<i>June 2021</i>
Econometric Games—Team Member Selected as a member of the University of Rome Tor Vergata team University of Amsterdam, Amsterdam	<i>Apr. 2021</i>